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BOTHWELL CASTLE.

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THE west of Scotland is rich in ruined castles of beauty and of historic interest. One of special note is Bothwell in Clydesdale, a grand edifice of the thirteenth century. Most likely it was enlarged during the occupation of the English, and of all the castles of that century may be counted the finest ruin in Scotland.

At that period it was possessed by the De Moravia, or Moray family. The castle was taken by Edward I., and by him made over to Aymer de Valence, Earl of Pembroke, governor of that region of Scotland. It was in the hands of the English a good deal till 1337, when the Scotch retook and dismantled it. The castle then passed by marriage to the Douglasses, and was held by that powerful family till their forfeiture under James II., 1445. Now it belongs to the Earl of Home.

Bothwell is beautifully situated on a rocky headland with steep banks on the south and west of the Clyde's broad waters, while on the north and east it was cut off from the adjoining level land by deep, wide ditches, the outlines of which may still be noted. The castle consists of a large courtyard surrounded by walls of great height, strengthened at the corners with round, square towers, while a donjon of majestic size "dominates" the whole. The length of the building is 325 feet by 140 feet in width. The donjon is a grand

tower 65 feet in diameter and 90 feet to the top of the parapet. The way in which the circular outline of the "keepe" is broken with a spur to receive the entrance door and portcullis is well worthy of note, as also the large stone chapel, built, no doubt, by the Douglasses, their arms being carved there in more places than one. They were probably constructed by Archibald, surnamed "the Grim," about the year 1400. The ornaments and mouldings tally with those of that time, and correspond with Saint Bride's at Bothwell, founded by the said Archibald "the Grim" in 1398, bearing his arms. The College of Lincluden, near Dumfries, was also restored by him.

The different towers were in recent dates called the "Valence Tower," the "Douglas Tower," and "Hamilton Tower," from which it may be concluded that Aymer de Valence added to the castle in the time of the English occupation. Its beauty must have been greatly destroyed in the War of Independence, when it often changed owners, and was dismantled in 1377. The style of the later masonry is much inferior to the earlier work, the junction being easily traced. The noble Castle of Bothwell is a rare specimen of the period in castellated architecture, when the barons, tired of the narrow bounds of their donjons, built spacious halls round the "Enceinte." There is a noteworthy example of this change in the large hall and chapel, no doubt constructed by the Douglas family, their armorial bearings being carved there in different places, probably engraved by Archibald "the Grim." The corbals, near the parapet, are obviously placed there to defend the doorway, while a drawbridge has also been worked from the portcullis room.

The mother of Alexander III. was Marie de Coucy, sister of Engherrard de Coucy, who built the great Castle of Coucy, which bears a remarkable likeness to Bothwell. A passage runs from the moat of the donjon through the wall where the flues reach the foot, so that they may be washed out by water let off by the moat. (There is a postern door from the moat, leading to the outside ditch). In castles of this type there is generally a private way of escape from the donjon, to which Bothwell is no exception.

It would appear in this instance the passage of refuge was

